

(a)

ሃሳብገሳፂ	bàlákàwúli	unexpectedness; sandgrouse (a kind of bird)
ሠጥኤ	játùrú	hyena
ሃፕሩኃ	kòlijí	washing water
ፂ፻	wàlá	slate
ተሃብላህ	kúmayira	advertising
ሃገላሰቸፎህ	tùbabumóri	Christian priest
ጋፕገሳፂ	?	uncircumcised boy
ፂህ፻	?	match-seller
?	kòrikóri	rust
?	báwò	because

(b)

Ἰἶἰἰἰἰἰἰ	márajàba	hail!
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	jílasama	hippopotamus
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	kòrəkaraśí	gerontocracy
ἰἰἰἰ	kàna	may it be that
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	bàsitéme	wide-meshed sieve
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	nàmátòrokó	hyena
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	?	rainbow
ἰἰἰἰἰἰ	?	light (of a lamp)
ἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰἰ	?	a kind of midges; honey from such midges
?	jàmanaké	the joys, pleasures of youth
?	létεε	letter, missive
?	bìlakóro	uncircumcised boy

⚠ The N’Ko script was invented in 1949 by the Guinean enlightener Souleymayne Kante.

The Bamana and Maninka languages belong to the Manding group of the Mande language family. They are spoken in Mali, Guinea and other countries in West Africa. These languages are very close to one another; the distinction between them is of no consequence to the problem.

—*Ivan Derzhanski*